

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1167

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to congratulate the Milligan University Buffaloes disc golf teams, 2026 College Disc Golf National Champions.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor and commend those extraordinary athletic teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to the State of Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors of this State; and

WHEREAS, the Milligan University Buffaloes disc golf teams recently made history, winning both the men's and women's Division I College Disc Golf national championships for the first time in program history; and

WHEREAS, in the men's competition, the Buffaloes foursome of Ben Wagner, Ethan Bishop, James Blocker, and Zac Nelson took top honors from among the forty-eight teams competing in the national championship at Rock Hill, South Carolina; and

WHEREAS, in the women's competition, Milligan Buffaloes Ari Timm and Grace Sanderson won a thriller after four rounds of play, as Ms. Timm made a birdie putt from distance on the final hole to clinch the title; and

WHEREAS, a powerhouse collegiate disc golf program, Milligan University won its first national title at the Division III level in 2025, launching the Buffaloes on the trajectory that saw them claim two more national championships this season; and

WHEREAS, the Milligan University Buffaloes enjoy the expert guidance and leadership of Head Coach Tim Barr and Volunteer Assistant Coach Zach Melton; and

WHEREAS, in addition to the teammates listed above, the Milligan University disc golf team includes Aaron Walker, Owen Gibson, Harrison Greene, Jett Carter, Chris Berney, Sean Pagenkopf, John Bernard, Stuart Kitchings, Ethan Reab, Isaiah Crawford, Spencer Brown, Michael Nickens, Hailey Crouch, and Karyn Makwerere; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Milligan University disc golf teams epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in honoring this extraordinary group of young men and women who have indelibly written their names for all time into the annals of collegiate disc golf; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the members and coaches of the Milligan University disc golf teams upon winning the 2026 Division I College Disc Golf men's and women's national championships and extend to them our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.